THE CHISOKU FILTER · 知足

Four questions before *any* AI project.

Score your project from 0 to 2 on each question. The total tells you whether to **start**, **redesign the scope**, or **wait**. It takes about two minutes, and it is built on the maths from the video: reliability multiplies along a chain, so the shape of the work matters more than the cleverness of the model.

PROJECT Name the AI project you're scoring

1 *How long is the chain between checkpoints?*

Lusser's Law: reliability multiplies. At 95% per step, twenty unchecked steps succeed only 35.8% of the time. A hard check resets the chain.

- **2 pts** — Three steps or fewer between hard checks
  Each short run ends in a rule-based check: a sum, a match, a schema, a test that passes or fails.
- **1 pt** — Some checks, but soft
  Checks every 4–6 steps, or checks that rely on judgment rather than rules.
- **0 pts** — Long unchecked chains
  The AI takes many steps in a row with no hard check, or a model grades its own work.

2 *Is the AI translating, or judging?*

Models are strong translators and weak strategists. Turning messy input into structured output can be verified. Judgment calls cannot.

- **2 pts** — Translating
  It turns mess into structure: emails into rows, PDFs into fields, notes into a schema.
- **1 pt** — Mixed
  It translates, but some outputs involve judgment, and a person approves those.
- **0 pts** — Judging
  It decides on its own: approves refunds, sets prices, makes exceptions to policy, picks strategy.

3 *What breaks if it's wrong at 2 a.m.?*

The O-ring rule: in tightly linked work, one failure can take the value to zero. Keep the blast radius small enough that failure means a delay, not a disaster.

- **2 pts** — A delay, not a disaster
  It writes only to a staging area. A person opens the inner door before anything goes live.
- **1 pt** — Contained, with effort
  It touches live systems, but with limits, logging and a tested rollback.
- **0 pts** — Real damage
  It can pay money, email customers or change live records directly, with no staging step.

4 *Can you walk away cheaply?*

The J-curve: every new machine costs money before it pays. If the pilot fails, you should lose weeks, not years, and learn something either way.

- **2 pts** — Cheap exit
  A pilot in weeks, no lock-in, nothing that can't be switched off on Friday.
- **1 pt** — Moderate commitment
  An annual licence or some restructuring, but you could unwind it within a quarter.
- **0 pts** — Locked in
  Multi-year contracts, a reorganisation or heavy sunk cost before you have any proof.

Q1 score: ____ Q2 score: ____

Q3 score: ____ (0 = stop) Q4 score: ____

Total: ____ / **8**

7–8 start · 4–6 redesign the scope · 0–3 don't start yet